

Test 2

READING AND USE OF ENGLISH (1 hour 15 minutes)

Part 1

Questions 1–8

For each question, choose the correct answer.
Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

The remarkable nature of camels

Camels have long been known for their ability to go weeks at a 1 without needing to drink water. This makes them particularly 2 animals for transporting goods across dry environments.

Many people are under the 3 that the prominent humps on camels' backs are used to store water. 4, the humps actually contain fatty tissue which is used as a source of energy when food is 5 The camels' humps also help the animal maintain its body temperature, which is important in the desert, where temperatures can be extremely high during the day and fall dramatically at night.

During the day, a camel's fur and the fatty tissue of the hump 6 as a kind of heat barrier, blocking hot air from reaching the skin. This 7 protection from outside heat. At night, the fat in the hump is broken down and some heat energy is released, thus 8 the body temperature does not get too low.

Test 2

- | | | | | |
|---|--------------|--------------|------------|----------------|
| 1 | A time | B period | C length | D moment |
| 2 | A worthwhile | B beneficial | C suitable | D favourable |
| 3 | A idea | B impression | C notion | D belief |
| 4 | A Moreover | B Besides | C However | D Nevertheless |
| 5 | A infrequent | B scarce | C rare | D uncommon |
| 6 | A play | B act | C perform | D move |
| 7 | A gives | B makes | C lets | D puts |
| 8 | A confirming | B enabling | C allowing | D ensuring |

Part 2

Questions 9–16

For each question, write the correct answer.
Write **one** word for each gap.
Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

Could short naps be good for us?

Sleep plays an important role in keeping the brain healthy. That's **9** people are advised to get between seven and nine hours every night. Napping – sleeping for short periods of time – also appears to be good for the brain. Even brief naps of five to fifteen minutes can instantly improve **10** well people perform mentally. But could regular napping also have long-term benefits? A recent study suggests **11** might.

People's brains naturally shrink as they age. **12** to past studies, poor sleep may also contribute to a decrease in brain volume and subsequently affect brain health. The new findings demonstrate that more frequent napping is associated **13** a larger total brain volume. This suggests that regular napping may help to make **14** for poor sleep and preserve brain health.

More research needs to be carried **15** on this subject. However, as far as we know right now, taking a brief nap during the day may be **16** only re-energising, but also beneficial to brain health.

Part 3

Questions 17–24

Read the text below. Use the word given in CAPITALS on the right to form a word that fits the gap.
Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

The Chrysler Building, New York City

The Chrysler Building is one of the most famous skyscrapers in New York City. The building was 17 constructed between 1928 and 1930. Just before its completion, it was decided by the architects to make an 18 to the top of the building – a 38-metre metal spire. The Chrysler Building gained the prestigious title of ‘tallest building in New York’, although 19 for its creators, this was only for a short period.

The building is well known all over the world because of its unusual decoration near the top of the tower’s exterior, based on the wheels of Chrysler cars, and because of the 20 of its interior. However, not everyone found the building’s design 21 when it first opened; indeed, it attracted a great deal of 22 Yet over time, New Yorkers have come to regard it with great affection. Its 23 may also have grown considerably in recent years owing to a number of 24 in several major films.

- Keyword List
- 17 ORIGIN
 - 18 ADD
 - 19 FORTUNATE
 - 20 ELEGANT
 - 21 IMPRESS
 - 22 CRITICISE
 - 23 POPULAR
 - 24 APPEAR

Part 4

Questions 25–30

For each question, complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first, using the word given. **Do not change the word given.** You must use between two and five words, including the word given.
Write only the missing words **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

25 Sam became a professional computer gamer five years ago.

PLAYING

Sam professionally for five years.

26 'This is the best day I've ever had!' exclaimed John.

NEVER

'I've day than this!' exclaimed John.

27 You will miss the bus if you don't run.

UNLESS

You won't run.

28 The party on the beach went ahead despite the rain.

EVEN

The party on the beach went ahead, raining.

Test 2

29 Patricia said she would take me to the supermarket in her car.

LIFT

Patricia offered to to the supermarket in her car.

30 Please tell me the minute you get your results.

KNOW

Please as you get your results.

Part 5

Questions 31–36

Read an article about archaeology. For each question, choose the correct answer.
Mark your answers **on the separate answer sheet**.

My fascination with archaeology

As a teenager, I watched a documentary about an Inca site in the Andes mountains of Peru. Archaeologists had uncovered a collection of artefacts, including pottery and textiles, dating back over five hundred years. Using a range of scientific techniques along with historical and anthropological knowledge, the team were able to work out much of the story of how the items would have been used and what they meant to those who created them, all of which offered a glimpse of how those people lived. It was astonishing to find out that discovering and explaining such mysteries could be an actual job. Archaeology and the challenge of making the strange comprehensible took a hold of me.

Before university, I offered my services on an archaeological dig in England that was willing to let me visit for a week. There was a muddy field for camping and a tent with chairs, tables and a limitless supply of tea served in brown-stained mugs. The casually dressed archaeologists hardly looked like professors, but were clearly extremely knowledgeable, piecing together the history of a site that spanned thousands of years of human activity. I helped excavate animal bones, food remains and burnt wood in the foundations of a building. To an untrained eye, there would have been no traces above ground, just a grassy field. But to those who could read the landscape, its history was extremely apparent.

Studying archaeology, I grew to appreciate how material remains reveal our past. Many of these remains are items that were discarded in waste deposits. Even what is preserved on ancient teeth tells us about past diets. Evaluating these numerous remains involves looking at how they are connected, for example, where the bits of a tool are in relation to a fireplace, how a site is positioned in relation to the sunrise, or has been shaped by generations of people living there. From all this, archaeologists build a web of knowledge about how humans through time did many things, mostly to tackle the everyday challenges of life that humans

have always faced. Whether it's to discover how a rainproof roof was built, or how babies were carried, curiosity is what drives our work.

After graduating, I did a day's work at a site on a Scottish farm near a prehistoric river crossing. There's evidence of over 10,000 years of human activity along the riverbank and in the surrounding fields. The day I helped out I was required to dig into a drain filled with earth on the outer edges probably used for keeping water off the farmland. None of the other archaeologists was sure of its extent, or whether anything interesting lay in the ancient earth now filling the drain. I scraped away, finding nothing but stones, lumps of clay, and then there it was – the smooth head of a long, thin pin made of cow bone. I was thrilled to be the first individual to hold it for nearly two thousand years – the last **may well have been the one who dropped it**.

Some magical archaeological encounters have been with areas of land. South-west England's bronze age rows of standing stones are fabulous. In the grassy hills of Yorkshire, I have explored the fascinating rock art carved into boulders. Further north among the narrow valleys between the mountains lie ancient piles of stones, perhaps burial places, and more standing stones and rock carvings. It's amazing to explore the surroundings ancient people lived in, and wonder at the meaning and effort of what is left behind. We can't be sure of all the answers but the questions are intriguing.

Mastery of archaeological skills brings confidence, control, and self-discipline. On one dig, I was watching archaeologist Paul Hardy as he dug back layers of sandy soil. '**Well, well,**' he muttered making me desperate to know what he had spotted. He informed me that as yet nothing of significance was in sight, but he had sensed a slight variation in the texture of the soil, and was convinced he was onto something. Sure enough, it turned out he'd reached the edge of an ancient wall. Such occurrences seem like magic, but actually result from years of expertise in the field of archaeology.

Test 2

- 31 What aspect of the documentary she saw particularly impressed the writer?**
- A** the nature of the work done by archaeologists
 - B** the length of time materials could be preserved for
 - C** the complexity of the technology used for the research
 - D** the accuracy of the information revealed about ancient life
- 32 What does the writer suggest about the archaeological site she worked on before university?**
- A** Its regular workers were required to have extensive training.
 - B** Expert skills were needed to understand the location's potential.
 - C** She found the conditions there tough to deal with.
 - D** The items she discovered there were only of minor importance.
- 33 What point does the writer make about archaeologists in the third paragraph?**
- A** Things that were once considered valuable can be useless to them.
 - B** They are able to build a picture by making links between objects.
 - C** Their findings can enable a deeper understanding of human psychology.
 - D** The purpose of objects that they uncover can be difficult to explain.
- 34 What does the term 'one' refer to?**
- A** an ancient tool
 - B** an archaeologist
 - C** a person in the past
 - D** part of an ancient animal
- 35 The writer's main aim in the fifth paragraph is to**
- A** examine how similar ancient people were to modern ones.
 - B** explain why much of ancient history can never be fully understood.
 - C** illustrate the pleasure that can be taken in the mysteriousness of the past.
 - D** express surprise at how remains found in different landscapes are interpreted.
- 36 The words 'Well, well' as used by Paul Hardy indicate**
- A** his satisfaction at seeing something unusual.
 - B** his lack of need for any assistance.
 - C** his certainty about what he had found.
 - D** his awareness of a potential development..

Part 6

Questions 37–42

Read an article about being a stuntman. Six sentences have been removed from the text below. For each question, choose the correct answer. There is one extra sentence which you do not need to use.
 Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

My job as a stuntman

Imagine this scene from your typical summertime blockbuster film: the thieves sprint from the bank to an awaiting getaway car, which takes off with the police in hot pursuit. It's a high-speed game of cat and mouse as the cars zoom through the city streets, dramatically weaving, turning and leaving explosions in their wake. The camera shows a close-up of the movie's star at the wheel, but when they zoom out, we all know it's not really him at the controls: it's a stuntman.

Movie studios typically don't like to risk their investment in their actors' million-dollar smiles. 37 This means stuntmen star in some of the coolest, most exciting and most dangerous parts of movies. This has always made this profession highly desirable, if very hard to get into.

Greg Tracy has been doing very well in the business for more than three decades now. He's starred in big Hollywood movies such as the *Bourne* and *Fast and Furious* series. 38 In what he calls his 'downtime', he races for the Italian motorcycle-manufacturing company Ducati and has won an annual automobile race to the summit of Pikes Peak in the US many times. A confirmed action freak, he's well qualified to tell us about what it's like to be a stuntman.

Greg says he got into the industry by accident. The son of a motorcycle-racing father, he started competing in races when he was 13 years old. He turned professional at the age of 16, racing in a few National Championship races, but switched to go-kart racing at 18, and then car racing. While recovering after a major accident, his roommate,

who was working in the film business, introduced Greg to people who were looking for stuntmen. He started with the odd job here and there. 39 This was despite not having given up entirely on his racing career.

According to Greg, his car- and motorcycle-racing background gave him something that other stunt guys didn't have at the time. 40 He considers *Driven*, a film starring Sylvester Stallone as a racing driver, as his first big break in terms of movies. Some of the stunt driving in that movie was done by a few of the biggest stunt drivers in the business, guys like Steve Kelso and Andy Gill. He learnt a lot from working with them.

A stuntman needs a set of distinctive skills, and for Greg, this is motorcycle and car racing. There are schools out there that promise to teach you these skills. Greg does see the value of stunt schools, despite never having attended one. Ultimately, however, he says you need to find someone who will take you under their wing and give you practical experience. 41

As for the question of whether to concentrate on a single skill, like fighting or driving, or trying to become adept at as many different skills as possible instead, Greg says having a very specialised skill is probably the best way to get started in a stunt career. 42 You're more likely to be noticed this way. In the end, though, Greg says possessing skills isn't enough: inner strength and commitment to your dreams are what's needed to succeed in his competitive business.



Test 2

- A** This means that whether it's martial arts, gymnastics or whatever, it's beneficial to be able to do one or two things at an exceptional level.
- B** It's this kind of behaviour that separates a stuntman who can make a successful career from the many who fall.
- C** But more and more regular and substantial work came his way, which he accepted.
- D** This personal approach is the best way to learn the ins and outs of a very unique business.
- E** So when it's time to leap from burning buildings, jump from a window or soar over a bridge on a motorcycle, they bring in the trained professionals.
- F** The specific skills set he developed from it meant he had an advantage in securing work in action films that were starting to become more popular.
- G** This high-profile work has been supplemented with stunt-driving jobs on television.

Part 7

Questions 43–52

Read a magazine article about working as a lifestyle blogger. For each question, choose the correct section. Each section may be chosen more than once.
Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

How I became a full-time blogger

Héloïse Rosset on giving up an office job for life on the internet

A

I've been a full-time lifestyle blogger for almost seven years now, but my path was definitely not a straight one. I guess my first blog started after obsessively (and sneakily) following a blog when I should have been working. My co-workers and I fell in love with a story about a girl from the US who'd married a prince. We'd look over our cubicles in the offices of our marketing company, sharing thoughts about the blog during the day and in between meetings. I didn't know her or why I cared so much, but I just felt compelled to continue reading about her ongoing story. Then I thought about my own life stories and had the craving to write. This is how my first blog came into being. I wrote this anonymously, focusing on my high-school sweetheart, who's now my husband. I wrote a few dozen posts, sending them off into the world wide web. No one read these amateurish first attempts, of course, and I stopped after a while.

B

But I didn't give up on the idea and, a few months later, I decided to start a new blog – one that could help people. I called it 'Easy on the Pocket', and my idea was to search the internet for the best shopping deals in my city and share them all in one place. It did fairly well, but it was hard work: I'd regularly have to wake up on Sundays at 5 a.m. and work through the day and into the night. At its peak, the site was getting a few hundred hits a day, which is pretty good for a brand-new website, but as time passed, I began to realise my heart just wasn't in it and I was writing less and less. One day, I suddenly had the urge to go back to being more personal. I shared some mundane things about my life and, to my surprise, I received some positive comments back. I felt thrilled to know that what

I said meant something to someone else in the world. The blog became less about shopping and more about myself.

C

Just a couple of weeks later, I had a fall when I was rock climbing and injured my leg. Unable to go to the office for a few months, I was holed up at home. At the time, it felt like the worst thing that had ever happened to me. But it was a blessing in disguise because it renewed my commitment to blogging. I opened my laptop and my fingers started flying. I wrote about my injury on my blog and found that just writing down the words helped me feel better. I started commenting on other people's blogs, too, and discovered an online community where I felt I truly belonged. I changed the name of my blog to 'Héloïse On...' and started writing about all sorts of things. At first, I didn't tell any of my friends or family – not even my husband. I guess I felt a bit embarrassed.

D

As I posted more and more things on my blog, I developed confidence and expertise. I began paying more attention to what was working for others online. I started putting more time and effort into my blog, but after fully recovering from my injury, I had to go back to my office job. This meant it was difficult to find time to do all the things I needed to do, like writing posts and sharing images. Eventually, I decided I wanted to make money from what I loved doing, and make it my full-time job. So I quit my job at the marketing company to take a course in social-media management. It was a game changer. It helped me get super clear on my goals and I got practical tips from professional bloggers. With that confidence and knowledge, I've been able to devote all my time to blogging. I haven't looked back since.

Test 2

In which section does the writer mention

- a responsibility getting in the way of blogging? 43
- her desire to keep up to date with developments on a blog she was reading? 44
- making a conscious decision to develop skills she now uses when blogging? 45
- looking at a blog at an inappropriate time? 46
- making the most of a bad situation to work on her blog? 47
- a change in the main focus of a blog? 48
- how her enthusiasm for a blog declined over time? 49
- discussing a blog with others? 50
- how a blog inevitably came to an end? 51
- how blogging enabled her to regain a sense of wellbeing? 52

WRITING (1 hour 20 minutes)

Part 1

You **must** answer this question.
Write your answer in **140–190 words** in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet.

- 1** In your English class you have been talking about where people work or study nowadays. Now, your English teacher has asked you to write an essay.

Write your essay using **all** the notes and giving reasons for your point of view.

‘It’s better to work or study from home.’ Do you agree?

Notes

Write about:

- time management
- learning from others
- (your own idea)

Part 2

Questions 2–4

Write an answer to **one** of the questions in this part.
Write your answer in **140–190 words** in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet.
Put the question number in the box at the top of the answer sheet.

2 You see this announcement on an English-language travel website:

Articles wanted

Exploring somewhere new!

What is the best way to explore places as a tourist – on your own or with people you know? Why?
Are there any advantages in joining a guided tour?

The best articles will be posted on our website.

Write your **article**.

3 You have received this email from your English-speaking friend Jo:

From: Jo

Subject: Advice needed!

Hi!

I've booked a ticket to see my favourite band play at a concert. I was really looking forward to it until I discovered the concert's the same day as my cousin's birthday, and he's decided to have a big party! What should I do? I don't want to miss the concert or upset my cousin!

Yours,

Jo

Write your **email**.

4 A museum in your city has announced that it would like to make some changes and has asked visitors for suggestions. You visit this museum regularly and have decided to write a report for the manager of the museum.

In your report, you should:

- describe your experience at the museum
- suggest what changes to the museum would be useful
- explain how more people could be encouraged to visit the museum.

Write your **report**.

LISTENING (approximately 40 minutes)

Part 1

Questions 1–8

For each question, choose the correct answer.



Listening test audio

- 1 You hear a man telling a friend about his experience of shopping online for an electric toothbrush.**

How did he feel?

- A** concerned about the prices of the items on offer
- B** unsure whether to trust the information provided
- C** surprised at the range of models available

- 2 You hear two friends talking about how very dry conditions affected the trees in their village.**

What does the woman do during the conversation?

- A** report something positive about the situation
- B** explain the difficulties she had in trying to help
- C** recall a number of the effects she'd witnessed

- 3 You hear two friends talking about preparing vegetarian dishes.**

They agree that making them

- A** is surprisingly straightforward.
- B** is greatly expanding their cooking skills.
- C** occasionally means buying unusual ingredients.

- 4 You hear a woman telling a colleague about an exhibition of an artist's work.**

What did she think of the paintings on display?

- A** She particularly disliked one piece.
- B** She found them difficult to interpret.
- C** She would have preferred a greater variety.

Test 2

5 You hear a couple talking about spending a weekend on the coast.

Why are they both so keen to go there?

- A** It will provide a complete change of scene.
- B** It will ensure they both have a break from work.
- C** It will enable them to explore a new leisure facility.

6 You hear a college tutor giving a talk about uncovering dinosaur bones.

What point does the tutor find particularly interesting?

- A** Amateurs' contributions to science are still significant.
- B** Important discoveries can be made in very unlikely locations.
- C** The thrill of finding something never goes away.

7 You hear two students talking about the installation of an internet service on a mountain.

How does the man feel about it?

- A** impressed by the achievement
- B** critical of people's desire for it
- C** puzzled by the reasons given for introducing it

8 You hear a woman on a podcast talking about a novel she has read.

What does she say about it?

- A** The plot is thrilling.
- B** The descriptions are vivid.
- C** The characters are memorable.

Part 2

Questions 9–18

You will hear a woman called Katie Smith giving a talk about a trip to go rock climbing. For each question, write the correct answer. Write a word or short phrase.



Listening test audio

Going rock climbing

Katie prepared for her trip by going **9** to build up her strength.

Katie hadn't expected that the location for the climbing would be a
10

Katie explains that the area used to be a large **11** for serious climbers.

The fact that the location involved no **12** for beginners was the key attraction for Katie.

Katie's group soon learnt to identify the difficulty level of the rocks from the
13 on them.

Katie was pleased to end the first day without getting
14

Katie was grateful for the advice to take some **15** with her.

At certain points, Katie appreciated being able to use techniques she'd gained from
16 classes.

Besides climbing, Katie felt that the skills she improved most were those used in
17

Katie uses the word **18** '.....' to express how rock climbing has felt to her.

Part 3

Questions 19–23

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about their experience of going to live on a houseboat. How did each speaker feel about living on a houseboat?
For each question, choose the correct answer.
Use each answer only once. There are three extra answers which you do not need to use.



- | | | | |
|-----------|----------|---|---|
| Speaker 1 | 19 | A | frustrated by the number of challenges to deal with |
| Speaker 2 | 20 | B | concerned about frequently changing weather |
| Speaker 3 | 21 | C | fascinated to be learning more about nature |
| Speaker 4 | 22 | D | surprised by the levels of noise at times |
| Speaker 5 | 23 | E | delighted about making new friends |
| | | F | pleased to have got out of bad habits |
| | | G | excited about the possibility of future journeys |
| | | H | concerned about depending on other people |

Part 4

Questions 24–30

You will hear an interview with a man called Aaron Brown, a professional dancer who specialises in ballroom dancing. For each question, choose the correct answer.



- 24 What initially attracted Aaron to ballroom dancing?**
- A** the impact it would have on his fitness
 - B** the potential for making new friends
 - C** the opportunity to be the centre of attention
- 25 Aaron wanted Ellie to become his regular dance partner because she**
- A** kept calm in most situations.
 - B** was an easy person to talk to.
 - C** was just as talented as him.
- 26 Aaron thinks he and Ellie had their first win in a competition because they**
- A** were willing to take risks.
 - B** stuck closely to their plans.
 - C** felt more determined than usual.
- 27 How did Aaron feel after he and Ellie appeared in a recent movie?**
- A** embarrassed by the level of attention from the media
 - B** delighted to receive further invitations for similar work
 - C** surprised at the number of strangers who recognised them
- 28 What does Aaron say about how his parents have influenced him?**
- A** They taught him the importance of hard work.
 - B** They encouraged him to be competitive.
 - C** They gave him a sense of independence.

Test 2

29 What does Aaron love most about being a professional ballroom dancer?

- A** being able to share his passions with others
- B** having a life that is full of variety
- C** mixing with talented people

30 Aaron says that people who are new to ballroom dancing should avoid

- A** giving in to self-doubt.
- B** practising too much.
- C** thinking about how they look.

